

Charged Studio — Design System

"Built to perform. Charged to last." Dark, electric, premium. A single charge of yellow, used with intent.

This project is the living, code-ready design system for **Charged Studio** — a premium creative studio (a creative *partner*, not an agency) based in Exeter, Devon, UK, working with growing businesses across the UK. The studio leads with **websites**, then **software & apps**, then **SEO & digital presence**, with retainers/partnerships and branding as supporting offers.

Consumers link one file — [styles.css](#) — to inherit every token and webfont. The Design System tab renders the specimen cards under [guidelines/](#), the reusable components under [components/](#), and the full-screen recreations under [ui_kits/](#).

Sources

Everything here is derived from the brand documentation and asset exports supplied by the client. **No codebase, GitHub repo, or Figma file was attached** — the docs reference a Next.js + Tailwind implementation ([app/globals.css](#), [tailwind.config.ts](#), [next/font/google](#), [/public/*](#)) that was not shared. If that repo or a Figma library exists, attach it via the Import menu and this system can be reconciled against the real components.

Supplied source files (in [uploads/](#)):

File	Role	Status
BRAND-SYSTEM.md	v1.0 — the single source of truth. Merges + supersedes the two below; fixes the Anton-weight, white-vs-yellow-button, and hex conflicts.	✓ Authoritative
tone.md	Full voice & tone guide.	✓ Authoritative
seo.md	SEO / content guidance.	Reference
styleguide.html	Live rendered reference page — mirrors BRAND-SYSTEM.md.	✓ Verified tokens against this

brand.md	Older brand guide.	⚠ Superseded
design-system.md	Older visual rulebook.	⚠ Superseded (had wrong Anton weight, white CTA)
logo.svg · logo-dark.svg · logo-c.svg · favicon.svg	Logo set (standardised to #FFC100 / #020413).	✅ Copied to assets/
bolt-motif.svg	The lightning-slash graphic device.	✅ Copied to assets/bolt-motif.svg
Caramel-Regular.otf	Self-hosted wordmark typeface.	✅ Copied to assets/fonts/

Where the superseded docs conflict with [BRAND-SYSTEM.md](#), [BRAND-SYSTEM.md](#) wins. Notable corrections it makes: Anton ships in **one weight (400)** — never [font-bold](#); the **primary CTA is yellow** with near-black text (not white); logo hexes are the canonical [#FFC100](#) / [#020413](#).

Content fundamentals

Voice in one line: *Confident, warm, and direct. We know what we're doing and we care about your business.* Six traits drive every word: **Confident · Direct · Premium · Human · Invested · Electric.**

- **Person & address.** Speak as "we" (the studio) to "you/your business" (the client). First person singular only in the About/story voice (Charlie, the founder). Talk about the client's success, not the studio's services.
- **Confident, not hedged.** "We build" — never "we can help you build" or "we offer ... services". No qualifiers, no waffle.
- **One idea per sentence.** Short, declarative sentences. If a sentence can be split, split it. Lead with the benefit to the client, not the feature.
- **Casing.** Sentence case for headings and body. Anton display/headings render **UPPERCASE** as a type treatment (not by writing in caps). Eyebrows and button labels are **UPPERCASE** with wide tracking. CTAs are short and active: [START A PROJECT](#), [BOOK A CALL](#), [LET'S TALK](#), [FREE AUDIT](#).

- **No emoji.** The tone is sharp and premium — emoji are off-brand. Energy comes from the word "charged/electric" (used sparingly) and the yellow accent, not punctuation. Avoid exclamation overload.
- **Lead with websites.** Order of offer in any copy: websites → software/apps → SEO → partnerships. Branding supports; it is never the headline.

Words we use: build · sharp · partner · grow · digital presence · charged / electric / fired up (sparingly). **Words we avoid:** solutions · leverage · passionate about · world-class · seamless · innovative · ! ! ! !.

Examples (from [tone.md](#)):

- Hero ☒ "We build the website your business deserves." ☐ "We provide comprehensive branding solutions for businesses of all sizes."
- Services ☒ "Your website is your digital foundation. We build it to turn visitors into leads." ☐ "We offer custom website design services."
- About ☒ "Charlie started Charged with a belief most agencies don't act on." ☐ "Our team of experienced professionals is dedicated to excellence."

Visual foundations

Overall feel. Dark, electric, premium. The whole system lives on a near-black canvas; **yellow is the single accent and is rationed** — a highlight, never a wash. The benchmark bar: Linear (precise, grid-perfect), Vercel (confident, fast), Basement Studio (bold editorial type), Stripe (trust, hierarchy).

Colour. Four **locked** core colours: Charged Yellow [#FFC100](#), Near Black [#020413](#) (page), Dark Navy [#171E3A](#) (surfaces), Off White [#F7F7F7](#) (text/light sections). Extended tokens are derived from these: an accent ramp (hover [#FFCE3A](#), pressed [#E0A900](#), soft [rgba\(255, 193, 0, .12\)](#)), a raised surface [#1E2747](#), two hairline border alphas, a four-step text ramp, and a minimal feedback trio (success/error/focus). **Never** white text on a yellow button — always near-black ([--color-text-inverse](#)) for AAA contrast. Yellow is never used for long body copy.

Type. Three typefaces, each one job. **Anton** — display & headings, **one weight (400)**, intrinsically heavy; impact comes from size, UPPERCASE, and tight tracking ([-0.01em](#)), never [font-bold](#). **Inter Tight** — everything else (body, UI, nav, buttons, labels) at 400/500/600/700. **Caramel** — the logo wordmark and rare branded callouts only, once or twice per page at most. Display sizes are fluid via [clamp\(\)](#). Body line length 60–75ch; line-height 1.6.

Spacing & layout. 4px base unit (`--space-1...--space-32`). Container max **1280px** with **24px** side padding; text column caps at **720px** (~65ch). Section vertical padding `clamp(96px, 12vw, 128px)`. 12-column grid; default responsive `1 → 2 → 3` columns. Card padding 24–32px; grid/component gaps `32 → 64px`; heading→body gap 16–24px.

Backgrounds. The signature treatment (from `styleguide.html`) layers a soft radial yellow glow over a vertical near-black gradient: `radial-gradient(1200px 600px at 80% -10%, rgba(255,193,0,.08), transparent 60%) over linear-gradient(180deg, #020413, #060a1c)`, often `background-attachment: fixed`. Subtle `#020413 → #171E3A` gradients and optional fine grain/noise add depth. Imagery is **real project work only** — **no stock**; framed for a dark UI with a scrim where text overlaps.

The bolt / slash motif. The diagonal lightning-slash derived from the "c" is the core graphic device — used as low-opacity background texture, a section divider, or a large abstract accent shape, always in `--color-accent`. One charged moment per view; don't overuse it.

Radius. `sm 6` (inputs, badges) · `md 10` (buttons, small cards) · `lg 16` (cards, panels) · `xl 24` (hero media) · `full 9999` (pills, avatars).

Elevation. Dark UI leans on **borders + glow**, not heavy shadows. `--shadow-e1` raised cards · `--shadow-e2` nav/overlays · `--shadow-glow` (a yellow ring + soft yellow cast) for CTA hover and accent highlights.

Motion. Alive, never chaotic. Entrance ease `cubic-bezier(0.22, 1, 0.36, 1)`; durations 150/250/400/600ms. Signature patterns: **fade-up** (`y:16→0, opacity:0→1, ~500ms`), **stagger** children 0.08s, **hover-lift** `translateY(-4px)`, **marquee** 40s linear infinite. Trigger on `whileInView` with `once:true` (never on mount, never re-fire). Always honour `prefers-reduced-motion`.

States.

- *Buttons* — *hover*: primary brightens to `--color-accent-hover` + `--shadow-glow` + `translateY(-1px)`; secondary border & text go yellow; ghost text goes yellow. *Active*: primary darkens to `--color-accent-pressed`, returns to `translateY(0)`. *Disabled*: opacity 0.5, no pointer.
- *Cards* — *hover*: `translateY(-4px)` + border shifts to `rgba(255,193,0,.30)`.
- *Inputs* — *focus*: border → accent + a soft yellow ring `0 0 0 3px rgba(255,193,0,.25)`. *Error*: border → `--color-error` with helper text in the same colour.
- *Focus-visible (global)*: 2px `--color-focus` outline, 2px offset.

Borders & cards. Default card = Dark Navy surface, 1px hairline border (`rgba(247,247,247,.10)`), `--radius-lg` (16px), 32px padding, `--shadow-e1`, lifting with a yellow edge on hover. Dividers use the same hairline; emphasised borders / secondary buttons use the stronger `.20` alpha. No heavy drop shadows, no coloured-left-border cards, no rounded-everything — corners are intentional per the radius scale.

Transparency & blur. Reserved for the nav (transparent over the hero → on scroll: `#020413` @ 80% + `backdrop-blur` + bottom hairline + `--shadow-e2`) and for scrim over imagery. Not a decorative default.

Iconography

 **No icon system was specified or supplied.** The brand docs and `styleguide.html` use **no UI icon set** — the only brand glyph is the bolt/slash motif. The recommendation below is a flagged substitution; confirm or replace it.

- **Brand glyph — the bolt/slash.** `assets/bolt-motif.svg` (and the "c" mark `assets/logo-c.svg`) are the signature marks. Use the bolt as decoration/dividers/accents in `--color-accent`, not as a functional UI icon.
 - **UI icons — recommended: Lucide (CDN).** Clean, consistent 2px-stroke, rounded-join line icons that match the Linear/Vercel-grade premium-dark aesthetic the brand benchmarks. Load `lucide@latest` from CDN; render at `currentColor` so icons inherit text colour (muted by default, yellow on accent/hover). **This is a substitution — swap for the studio's real set if one exists.**
 - **No emoji**, ever — off-brand for the sharp/premium tone. Avoid unicode-glyph-as-icon hacks. Prefer the bolt motif or a Lucide line icon.
 - **Sizing:** match the optical line weight of Inter Tight; 16–24px in UI, stroke ~2px. Keep clear space; never recolour the bolt off-yellow.
-

Index / manifest

Root

- `styles.css` — the one entry point consumers link. `@imports` only.
- `readme.md` — this guide.
- `SKILL.md` — Agent-Skill front-matter so this folder works as a Claude skill.

tokens/ — CSS custom properties, one concern per file (all `@imported` by `styles.css`):
`fonts.css` (`@font-face` + Google import) · `colors.css` · `typography.css` ·
`spacing.css` · `radius.css` · `elevation.css` · `motion.css` · `base.css` (element defaults).

assets/ — `logo.svg` (light/primary) · `logo-dark.svg` · `logo-c.svg` (mark) ·
`favicon.svg` · `bolt-motif.svg` · `fonts/Caramel-Regular.otf`.

guidelines/ — foundation specimen cards (Colors, Type, Spacing, Brand) shown in the Design System tab.

components/ — reusable React primitives (Button, Badge, Card, Input, ...), each with `.jsx` + `.d.ts` + `.prompt.md` + a directory card.

ui_kits/ — full-screen recreations of the marketing site.

(Sections below the foundations are added as the build progresses — see the Design System tab for the current set.)

Brand

Background treatment

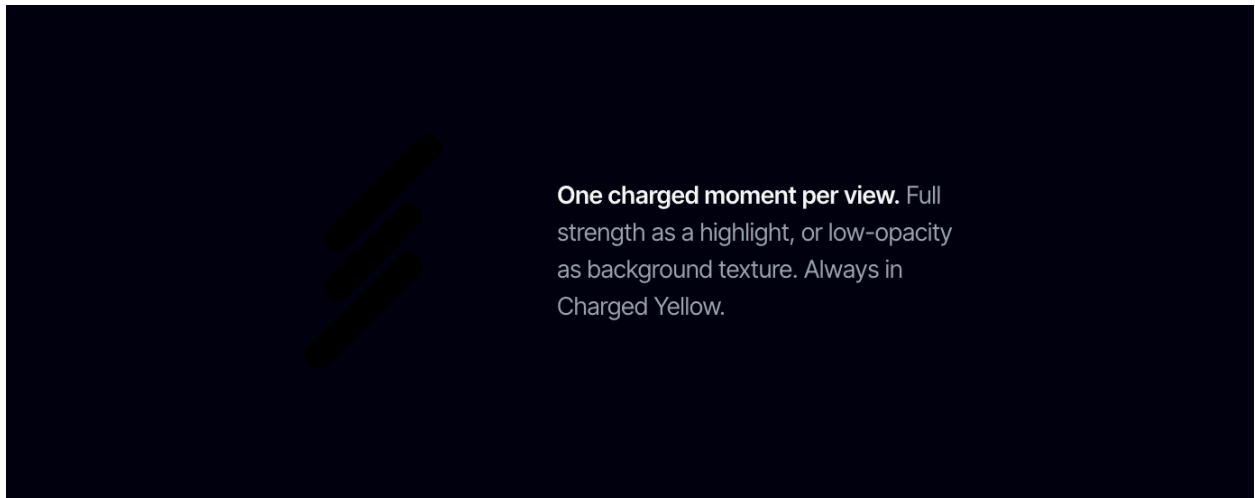
Radial yellow glow over a near-black gradient

SIGNATURE SURFACE

```
radial-gradient(1200px 600px at 80% -10%, rgba(255,193,0,.08), transparent 60%)  
over linear-gradient(180deg, #020413, #060a1c)
```

Bolt motif

The lightning-slash device — accent, texture, divider



Logo — dark

Near-black wordmark + yellow c · light surfaces only



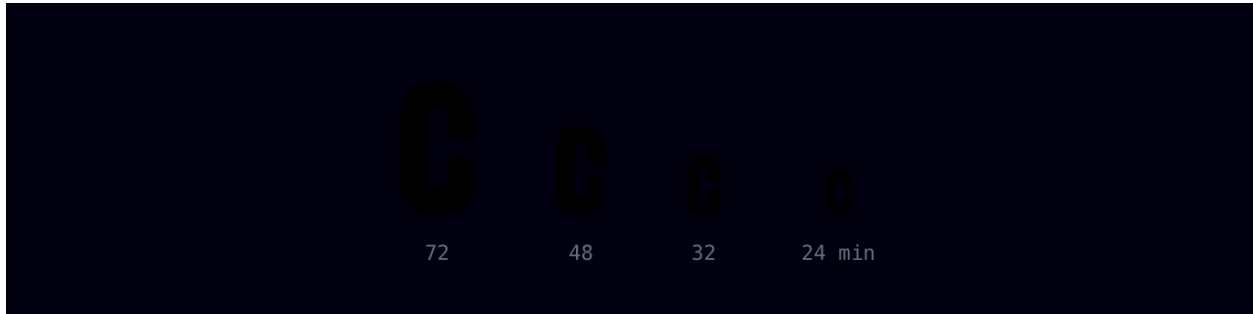
Logo — light (primary)

White wordmark + yellow c · for dark surfaces



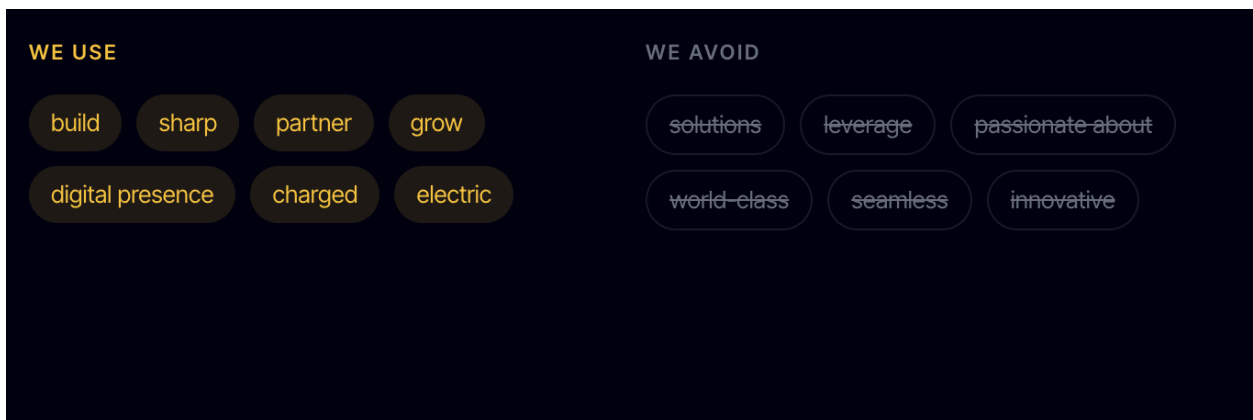
Logomark — the c

Yellow c for favicons, avatars, compact spaces



Voice — words

Confident, direct, premium · use these, avoid these



Colors

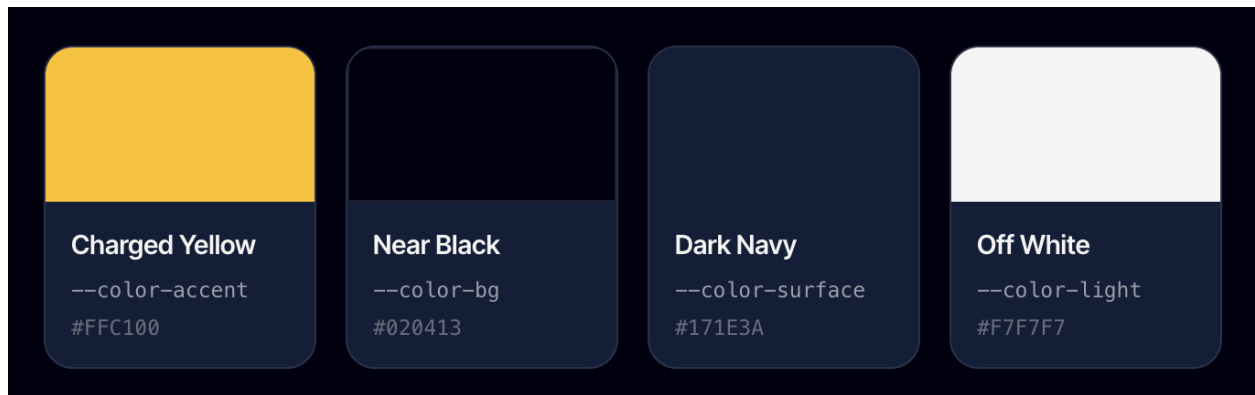
Accent ramp

Yellow states, derived from the locked accent



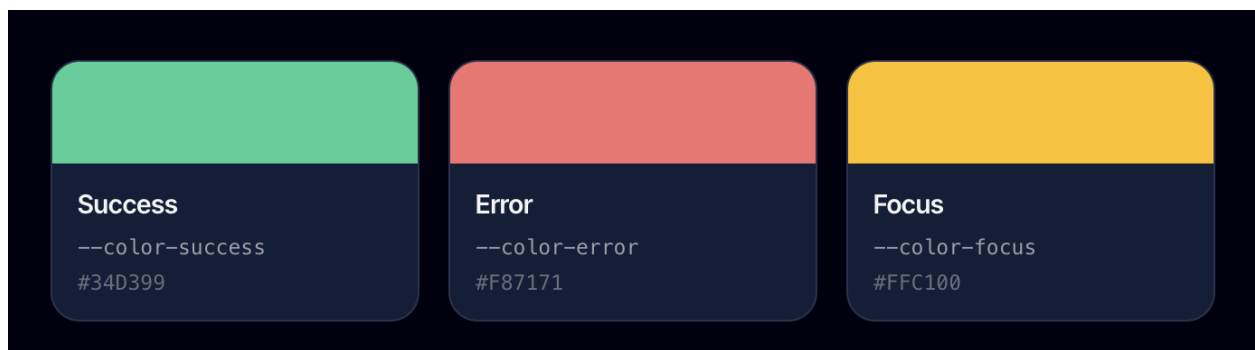
Core palette

The four locked brand colours



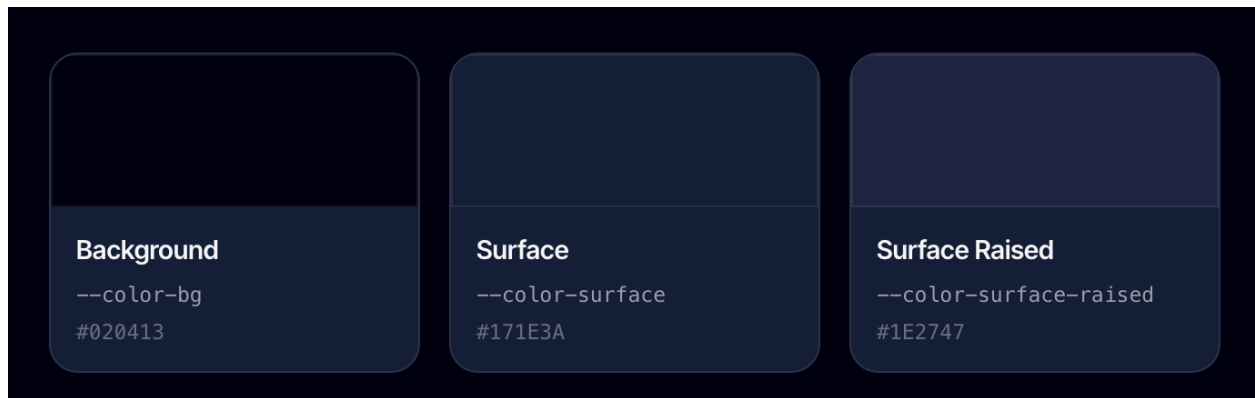
Feedback

Minimal form states — success, error, focus



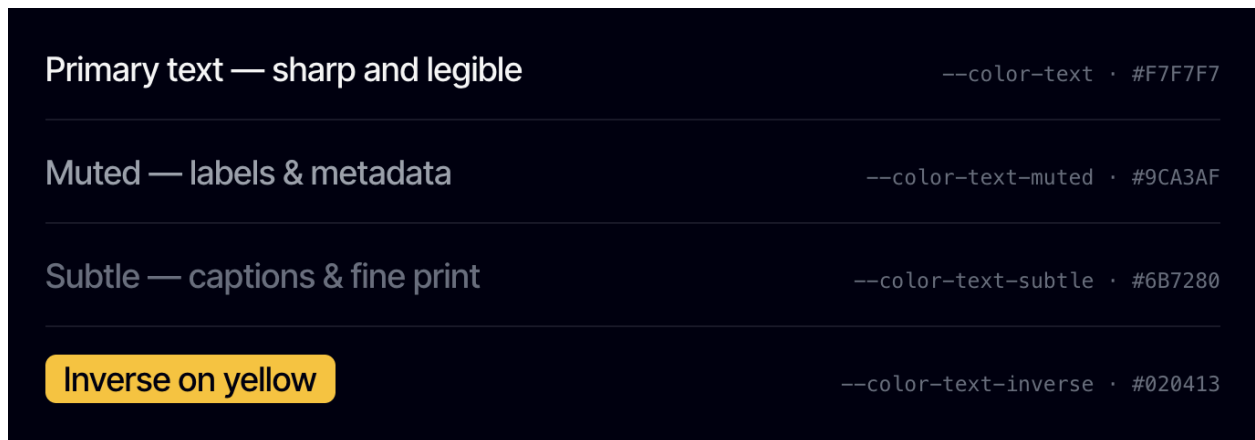
Surfaces

Dark layering: page, card, raised



Text ramp

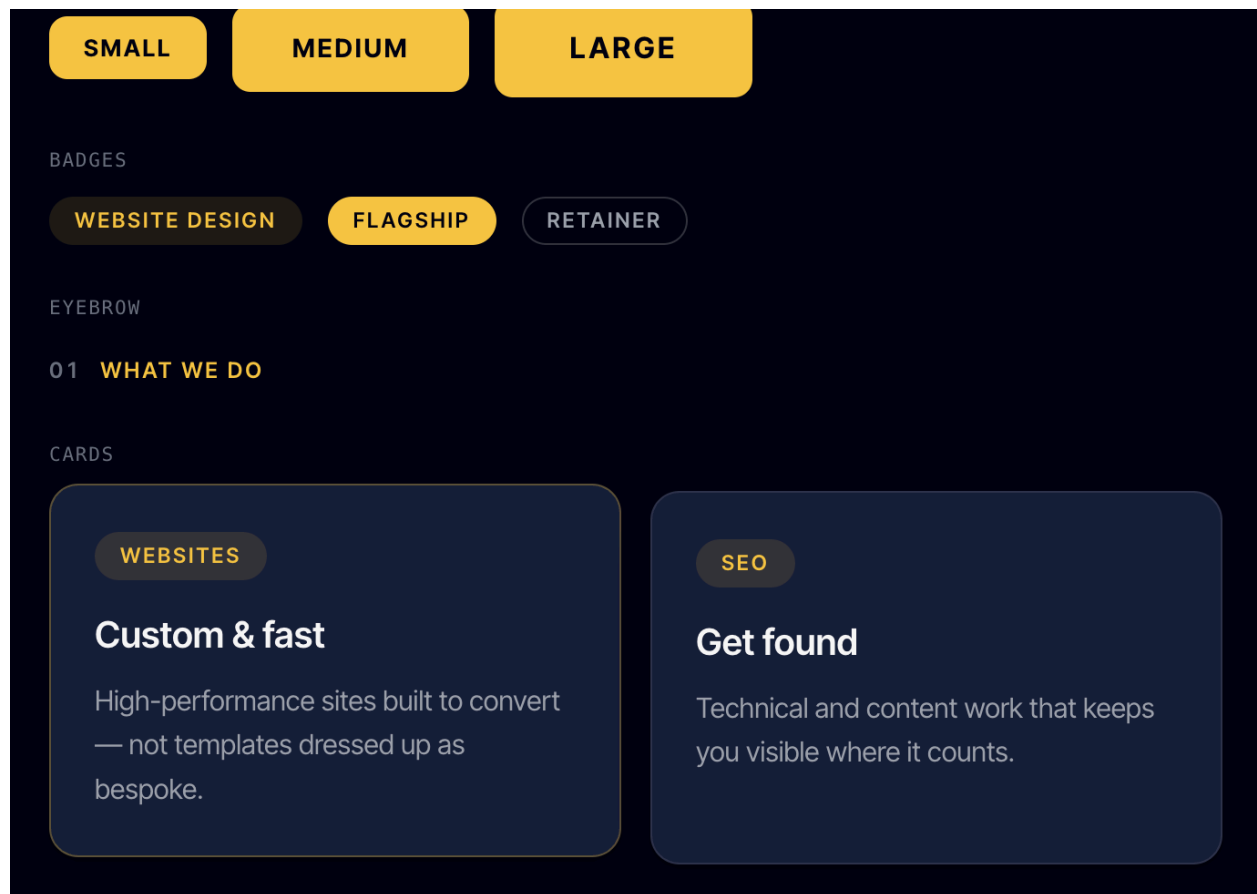
Four text weights for the dark UI



Components

Core

Buttons, badges, cards, eyebrow



Usage notes for Claude

Forms

Input — default, filled, error + actions

EMAIL

you@business.co.uk

NAME

Charlie Hart

COMPANY

Your business

Please add your company name

SEND ENQUIRY

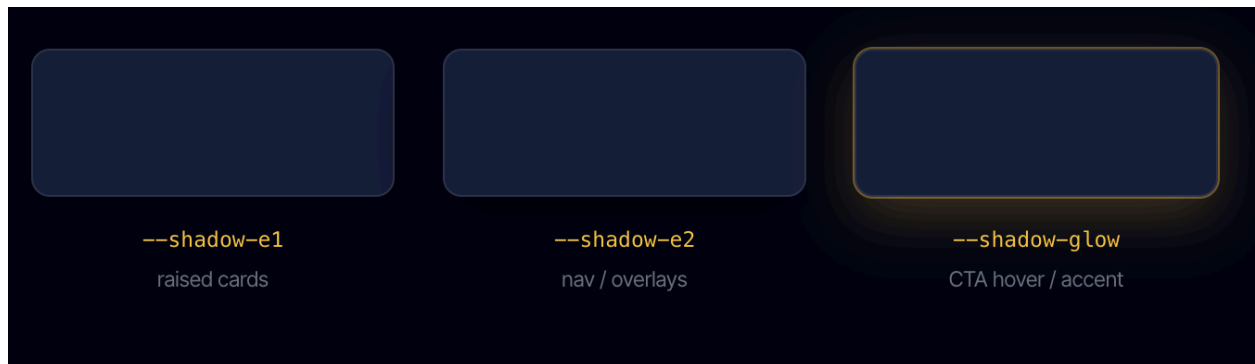
CANCEL

Usage notes for Claude

Spacing

Elevation

Dark UI leans on borders + glow, not heavy shadows



Motion

Easing & duration — alive, never chaotic

EASING		DURATION	
<code>--ease-out</code>	<code>.22,1,.36,1</code>	<code>--dur-fast</code>	150ms
<code>--ease-emphasized</code>	<code>.16,1,.3,1</code>	<code>--dur-base</code>	250ms
<code>--ease-in</code>	<code>.4,0,1,1</code>	<code>--dur-slow</code>	400ms
		<code>--dur-slowest</code>	600ms



Radius scale

6 / 10 / 16 / 24 / full



Spacing scale

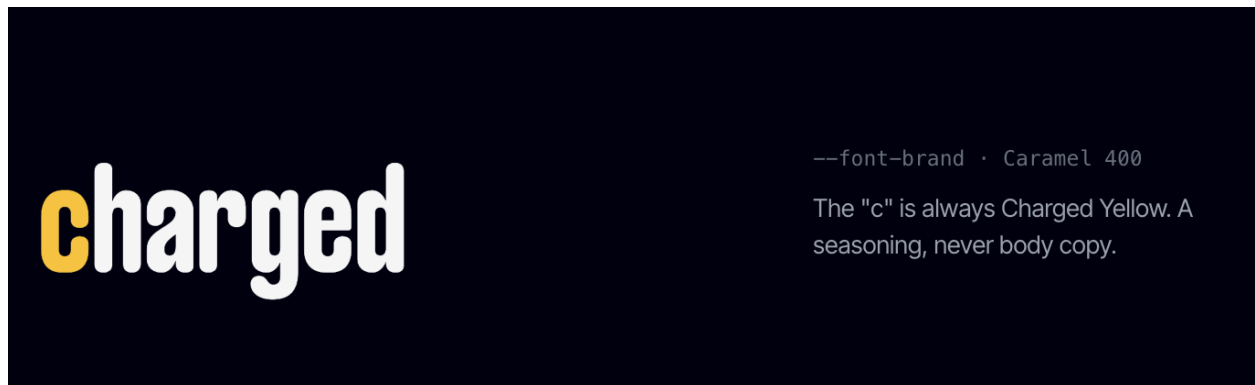
4px base unit — reference the token, not the pixel

<code>--space-1</code>		4
<code>--space-2</code>		8
<code>--space-3</code>		12
<code>--space-4</code>		16
<code>--space-6</code>		24
<code>--space-8</code>		32
<code>--space-12</code>		48
<code>--space-16</code>		64
<code>--space-24</code>		96
<code>--space-32</code>		128

Type

Brand wordmark — Caramel

Logo + rare branded callouts only — once or twice per page



Display & headings — Anton

One weight (400). Impact from size + uppercase, never font-bold.

DISPLAY · ANTON 400 · CLAMP(2.75-5REM)

BUILT ON BELIEF

H1 · ANTON 400 · CLAMP(2.25-3.75REM)

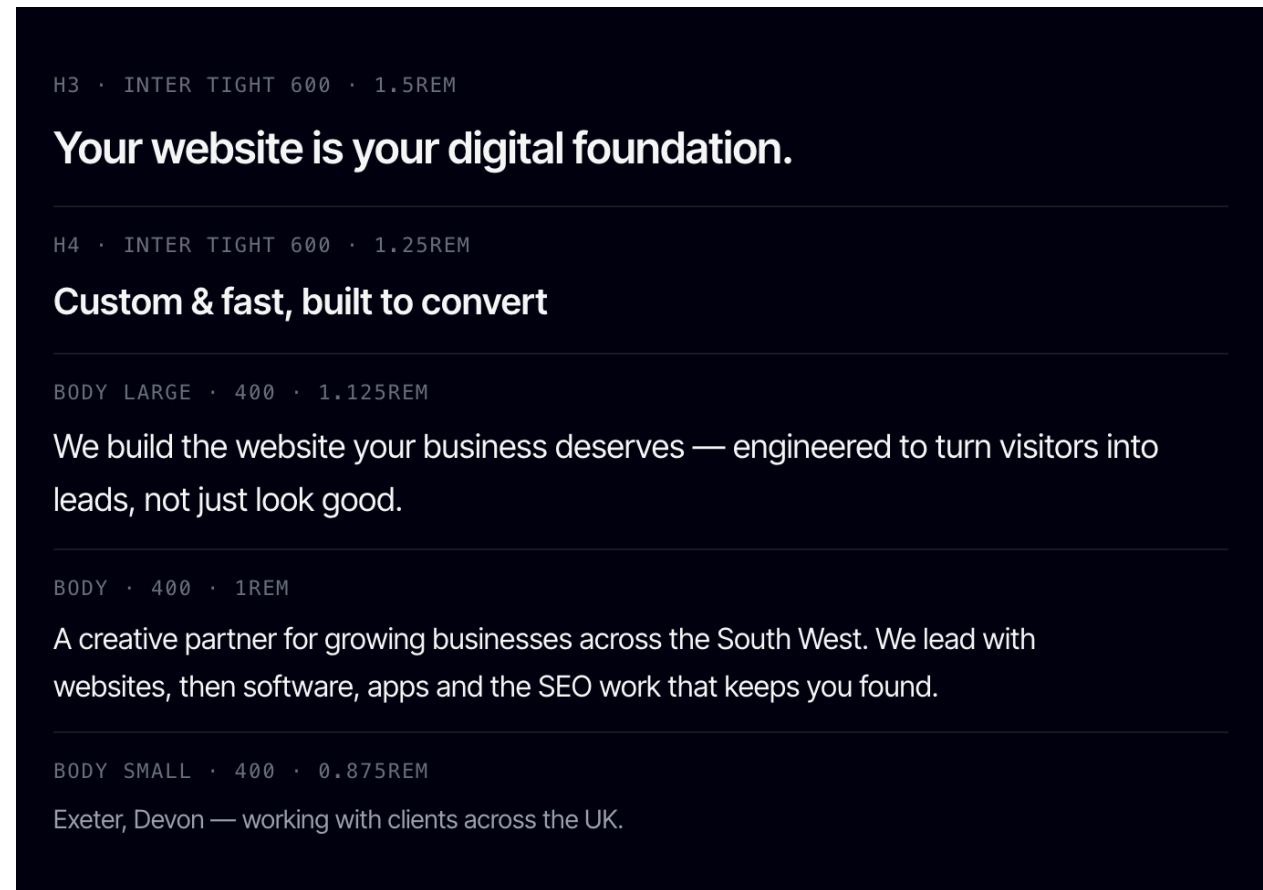
WE BUILD WEBSITES THAT WIN

H2 · ANTON 400 · CLAMP(1.875-3REM)

WHAT WE ACTUALLY DO

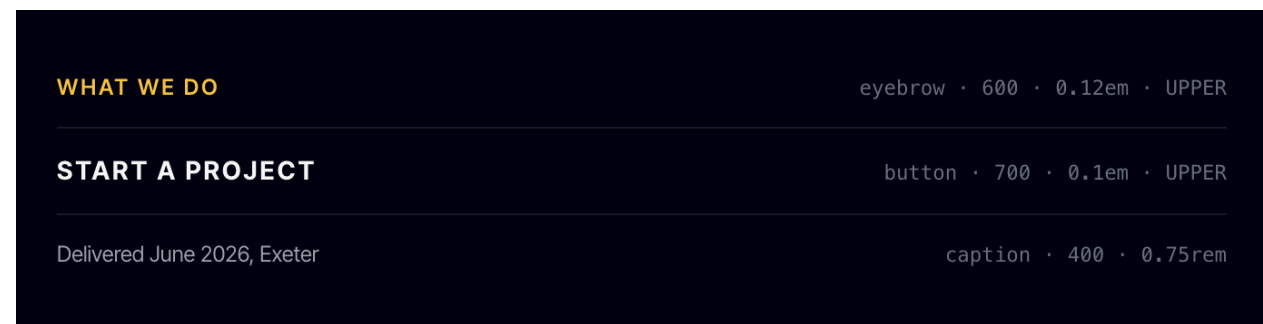
Headings & body — Inter Tight

H3/H4 sub-heads plus the body sizes



Utility type

Eyebrow, button label, caption



Website

website

Charged Studio marketing homepage

